ELENA MORALES

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I work at the intersection of product analytics, software engineering, and responsible data use. My projects and internships have involved experiment design, metric governance, self-service data tools, and user-facing applications for education and public services. I am especially interested in making analytics systems understandable: clearly defined metrics, visible assumptions, reproducible analysis, and interfaces that help teams act on evidence. I am completing a combined information sciences and computer science degree at UIUC and seeking product analytics, data product, or software roles for 2027.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign - Bachelor of Science - BS, Information Sciences + Computer Science — Expected December 2026 | Chicago, Illinois

Relevant Coursework: Data Structures, Database Design, Product Analytics, Human-Computer Interaction, Machine Learning, Privacy, Software Engineering, Causal Inference

EXPERIENCE

Product Analytics Intern | Northstar Learning — May 2026 - August 2026 | Chicago, IL

- Defined activation, engagement, and retention metrics for a learning platform serving 95,000 monthly users and reconciled event definitions across product and finance reports.
- Built SQL models and Amplitude dashboards for onboarding experiments, content discovery, and educator workflows, reducing ad hoc analysis requests by 34%.
- Analyzed a randomized checklist experiment and identified a 6.8% lift in first-week course completion with no increase in support contacts.
- Created a metric-change review template that documented owners, exclusions, backfill rules, and expected downstream impact.

Software Engineering Intern | CivicLayer Studio — September 2025 - December 2025 | Remote

- Developed a multilingual React and Django application that helped residents screen for 18 local assistance programs and prepare required documents.
- Improved form completion by 21% through progressive disclosure, saved progress, and field-level validation informed by usability sessions.
- Added audit logs and role-based access controls for nonprofit case workers handling sensitive application data.

Peer Learning Assistant - Data Storytelling | UIUC iSchool — January 2025 - Present | Champaign, IL

- Facilitated workshops on chart selection, uncertainty, accessible color use, annotation, and communicating limitations.
- Reviewed 120 student projects and created reusable examples for misleading axes, aggregation bias, and unsupported causal claims.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Experiment Registry and Guardrail Monitor / *Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, React, Statsmodels* — January 2026 - May 2026

- Built a registry for hypotheses, assignment logic, primary metrics, guardrails, analysis plans, and decision notes across simulated product experiments.
- Automated sample-ratio mismatch checks, sequential peeking warnings, and segment-balance summaries before results were unlocked.
- Generated plain-language result cards with effect sizes, intervals, power limitations, and links to reproducible notebooks.

Privacy Budget Explorer / *TypeScript, Next.js, Python, Differential Privacy* — September 2025 - December 2025

- Created an educational interface showing how epsilon, query count, clipping, and cohort size affect accuracy and privacy tradeoffs.
- Implemented simulated noisy counts and confidence ranges for 12 common public-data queries.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE HIGHLIGHTS

- Worked across Northstar Learning, CivicLayer Studio, and UIUC iSchool in roles requiring independent implementation, structured review, and clear status communication.
- Combined Product Analytics, SQL, Python with database, cloud, testing, and version-control workflows to move projects from initial requirements through documented validation.
- Balanced performance and reliability goals by measuring latency, throughput, data quality, or user completion before and after technical changes.
- Prepared design notes, test plans, demos, and handoff documentation so classmates, researchers, and internship teammates could reproduce results and maintain the work.

PROJECTS

Public Benefits Access Map / *Django, PostGIS, React, Mapbox* March 2025 - August 2025

- Mapped service locations, eligibility information, transit access, language support, and appointment requirements for four Chicago neighborhoods.
- Added mobile-first filters and printable summaries after interviews with community navigators.

Metric Definition Linter / *Python, SQLGlot, YAML, GitHub Actions* November 2024 - February 2025

- Validated analytics metric files for missing owners, inconsistent grains, unbounded joins, and undocumented filters.
- Produced pull-request comments with suggested fixes and examples from an approved metric catalog.

SELECTED TECHNICAL CONTRIBUTIONS

- Designed project architecture for Experiment Registry and Guardrail Monitor and Privacy Budget Explorer, separating interface, application, data, and infrastructure concerns to support iterative changes.
- Implemented validation and error-handling paths for expected inputs, malformed records, partial failures, retries, and recovery scenarios rather than testing only the happy path.
- Used automated unit, integration, or hardware/system tests to verify core behavior and added repeatable fixtures or seeded datasets for regression testing.
- Profiled or benchmarked critical workflows and used measured results to prioritize indexing, caching, batching, concurrency, memory, or communication improvements.
- Created deployment or build automation with version control and documented environment setup, configuration, observability, and rollback expectations.
- Presented technical tradeoffs to peers and nontechnical stakeholders, connected implementation choices to user or operational outcomes, and incorporated review feedback.

LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

- Design for America - analytics lead for a student team researching barriers to municipal-service access.
- Latinas in Tech campus chapter - organized portfolio reviews and alumni panels for 90 attendees.
- Illinois Data Science Club - led workshops on product funnels, experimentation, and metric design.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Analytics: SQL, Python, R, causal inference, experimentation, funnel analysis, cohort analysis

Data Tools: dbt, BigQuery, PostgreSQL, Amplitude, Mixpanel, Tableau, Looker Studio

Software: TypeScript, React, Next.js, Django, FastAPI, REST APIs

Research & Design: Usability testing, survey design, accessibility, data storytelling, metric governance

Workflow: Git, GitHub Actions, Docker, Jupyter, Notion, Figma

ACADEMIC APPLICATIONS

- Applied Data Structures, Database Design, and Product Analytics concepts when selecting data structures, algorithms, interfaces, and performance constraints.
- Used ideas from Human-Computer Interaction and Machine Learning to design storage models, data flows, communication boundaries, or experiment plans.
- Connected classroom work in Privacy to maintainable code organization, testing strategy, documentation, and team review practices.
- Completed technical writing and presentation deliverables explaining assumptions, limitations, evaluation methods, and next-step recommendations.
- Maintained reproducible repositories with setup instructions, sample data, issue tracking, and versioned changes suitable for independent review.

CERTIFICATIONS

- Amplitude Product Analytics Certification - 2026
- Google Data Analytics Professional Certificate - 2025

HONORS & AWARDS

- Siebel Center for Design Student Grant, 2026
- Dean's List, five semesters

ADDITIONAL DETAILS

Professional Interests: production-quality systems, measurable performance, careful testing, accessible documentation, and cross-functional delivery.

Profile Status: Synthetic testing profile; no real employment, credential, or identity claim is represented.

Links: github.com/elenamorales-sample | www.linkedin.com/in/elena-morales-product-sample | elenamorales.example.com